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ASSESSING KNOWLEDGE OF PATIENT EDUCATION AND TREATMENT TOWARDS CLASSICAL SCABIES AMONG HEALTHCARE WORKERS IN KINTA DISTRICT



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Key Message
Despite strong treatment knowledge among healthcare workers (HCWs), critical gaps in patient education (PE) create a major bottleneck, driving classical scabies (CS) treatment failure

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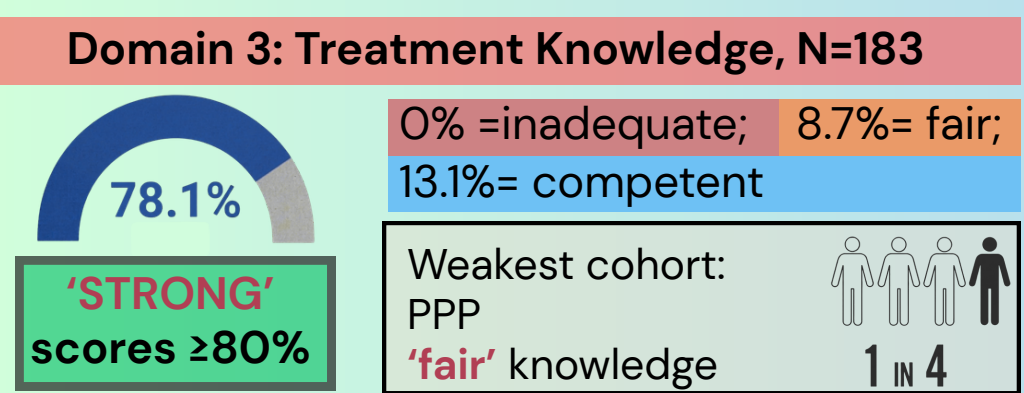
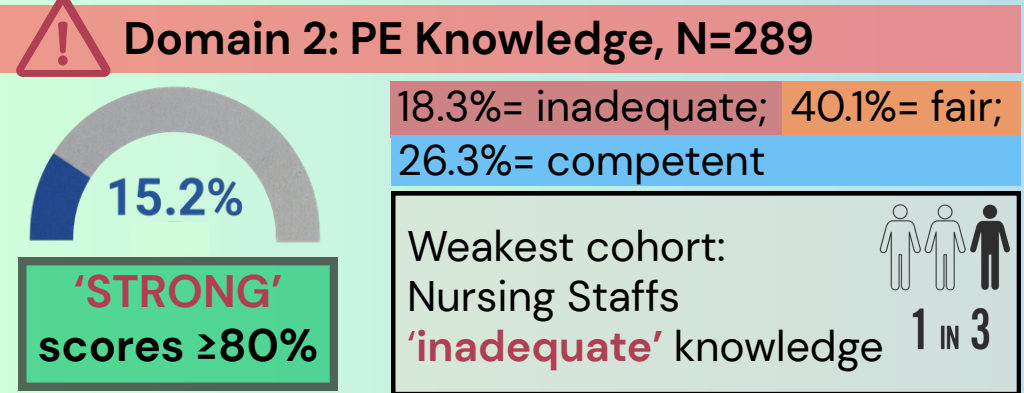
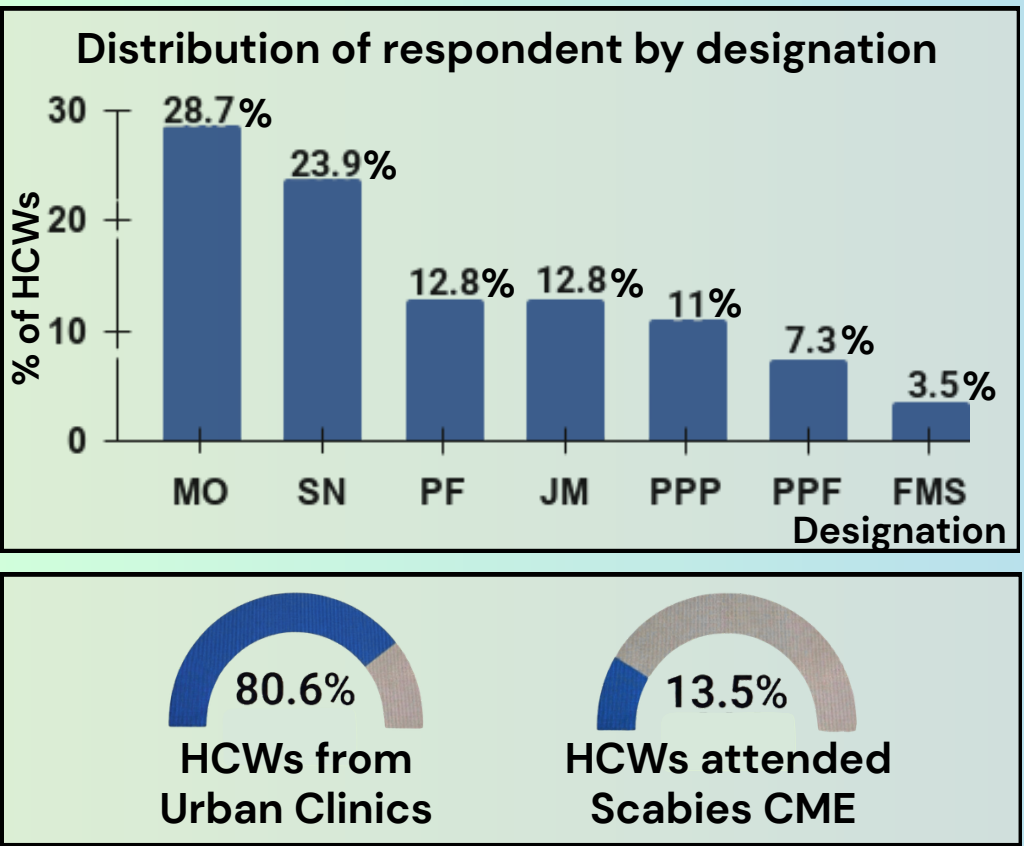
Introduction & Objectives

- Background:** CS is a highly contagious skin infestation caused by *Sarcoptes scabiei*. Persistent outbreaks highlight a critical gap in local primary care management.
- Objective:** To assess the level of knowledge on PE and treatment of CS among HCWs. To identify which group of HCWs needs CME (continuous medical education).

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Results

Total respondents achieved N=289
Subset (Prescribing or Dispensing Cadres) N=183
Domain 1: Demographic, N=289



Significance (Chi-square test), N=183

Significant	Not Significant
✓ Designation ✓ PE Knowledge	⚙️ CME

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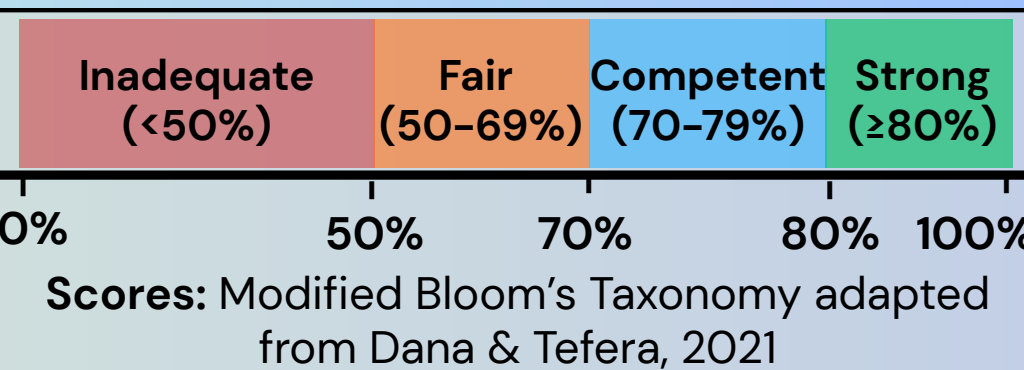
Declaration of conflict for all authors

- The authors declare no conflicts of interest.

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Methodology

- Study design:** Cross-sectional study
- Data collection:** June–November 2025.
- Sampling:** Conveniently via WhatsApp. Estimation N=268 HCWs in PKD Kinta.
- Tool:** 23-item online questionnaire developed via 2015 MOH Scabies guidelines.
- Validated:** 3 FMS with dermatology SME (Cronbach's $\alpha = 0.82$).
- Exclusion:** Unreachable and unconsenting
- Analysis:** 1 point per correct answer, converted to percentages and categorized following Modified Bloom's Taxonomy.



Domains	Cohort	
	*FMS, MO, PF, PPF & PPP	Nursing Staff (*SN & JM)
1. Demographics	✓	✓
2. PE Knowledge	✓	✓
3. Treatment Knowledge**	✓	✗

Note: *FMS= Family Medicine Specialist; MO= Medical Officer; PF= Pharmacist; PPF= Pharmacist Assisstant; PPP= Medical Assisstant; SN= Staff Nurse; JM= Community Nurse

**Nursing staff not included for treatment knowledge as they do not have prescribing or dispensing role.

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Discussions & Conclusion

Gaps: Treatment knowledge is strong, but PE is a critical weakness across all designation especially nursing staffs who are the front line educators.

Transform CME: Towards active, case-based workshops tailored by designation.

Practise: Improve patient communication by consistently using checklists and standardized visual aids.

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References

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